Store, share, and update client .env files in 1Password

Every client's environment file lives in one place: a Secure Note (1Password's free-text item) in that client's 1Password vault. If you remember one thing: **never send a credential** — point people at the vault, and send a private link (one that opens only for people who already have the vault) if they need help finding it.

SOP ID	HGM-SOP-WEB-001	EFFECTIVE	2026-09-01
VERSION	1.2	NEXT REVIEW	2027-03-01
OWNER	Web & Content Specialist (Kyle Zinger)	DURATION	~5 min, Phases 1–5; 30–45 min, Phase 6
TRIGGER	A new env file, or a changed value		

01 PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Purpose

Client website projects need configuration values — API keys, account IDs, secrets — to run. This puts the complete `.env.local` file (the plain-text settings file at the project root, one `NAME=value` per line) for every client in one controlled place in 1Password, so credentials stop moving through chat, email and shared drives, and anyone picking up a project can get running without asking a teammate to send them a file.

In scope

Every client website project that needs a `.env.local` file to run locally, and the complete contents of that file — every variable in it, not a filtered subset.

Out of scope

Production deployment configuration, version control, and scheduled audits of stored files. This is about storing, sharing and updating the file in 1Password, and where each value comes from. Nothing else.

ALWAYS TRUE

Four standing rules

True on every project.

1

The complete file goes in the note

Every variable and comment line, pasted exactly as it is on disk.

2

Update the date header on every change

Line 1, `# UPDATED YYYY-MM-DD — <name>`, is the only sign that a local copy is stale.

3

Announce every change

Post it in the **Web Team** Google Chat group. Nothing updates on its own.

4

Never send a key directly

Point people at the vault. A private link is fine: task 5.4.

02 PREREQUISITES

Everything below is needed before task 1.1 of any phase.

1 **1Password**

The desktop app, signed in to the HGM account.

2 **Client vault access**

Membership of the client's vault. Request from Gillian or Kyle in the **Web Team** Google Chat group.

3 **VS Code**

Used to create the file. Finder hides dotfiles and cannot.

4 **Service dashboards**

Access to the dashboard of each service that issues a key for the project, for Phases 2, 3 and 6.

Where the file lives

One Secure Note per client, stored inside that client's existing vault.

ELEMENT	EXACT VALUE
Vault	The client's vault (for example `Awayframes`), or `<Client> – Dev` where the client vault is shared beyond the dev team
Item type	Secure Note
Item title	`ENV – <Client> (.env.local)`
Line 1 of the note	`# UPDATED YYYY-MM-DD – <name>`

> **The prefix is deliberate**
>
> Searching `ENV –` in 1Password returns every environment file across every client vault in one view.

03 PROCEDURE

What are you trying to do?

Six procedures. They are independent — pick the one that matches your situation and go straight to it.

PHASE 1

Get a file onto your machine

Tasks 1.1–1.9. New machine, new project, or someone just changed a value.

PHASE 2

Update a value

Tasks 2.1–2.8. A key was rotated or replaced at the service that issued it.

PHASE 3

Add a new variable

Tasks 3.1–3.8. The project needs a value that is not in the note yet.

PHASE 4

Give someone access

Tasks 4.1–4.2. Someone new needs to run the project.

PHASE 5

Send a link to the note

Tasks 5.1–5.5. Point someone who already has access straight at the item.

PHASE 6

Remove someone's access

Tasks 6.1–6.5. Revoke, then rotate. Revoking alone is not enough.

Phase 1 — Get a file onto your machine

New machine, new project, or after someone updates a value.

1.1 Search 1Password for `ENV – <Client>`

The `ENV –` prefix narrows the search to environment files only, across every client vault.

> ⚠ **If the client has no vault yet**
>
> Ask Gillian or Kyle for one in the **Web Team** Google Chat group. Do not store the file anywhere else in the meantime.

1.2 Open the item `ENV – <Client> (.env.local)`

> 👁 **Expected result**
>
> A line beginning `# UPDATED` at the top of the note.

1.3 Read line 1 and confirm the date is not older than your last local copy

> ⚠ **If the note has no date header**
>
> Do not use it. Ask in the **Web Team** Google Chat group who edited it last and have them add one.

1.4 Copy the entire note contents

Comment lines included. Do not select a subset of variables.

> ⚠ **Missing screenshot**
>
> Expected an image at `fig_HGM-SOP-WEB-001_f1-note.png` — The Secure Note open in 1Password, date header on line 1, note body showing <code>NAME=value</code> lines and comments.

1.5 Open the project folder in VS Code

1.6 Right-click the project root in the Explorer pane and select New File

> ⚠ **Missing screenshot**
>
> Expected an image at `fig_HGM-SOP-WEB-001_f2-newfile.png` — VS Code Explorer right-click menu with New File highlighted, at the project root.

1.7 Name the file `.env.local` and press Return

> ⚠ **Create it in VS Code, not Finder**
>
> Finder hides dotfiles, so a file you create there will not show up afterward and you will make a second one.

1.8 Paste the copied contents into the file, then save with `Cmd + S`

1.9 Run the project locally

> ⓘ **If a variable is missing or a value does not work**
>
> A variable was added to the note after your last copy, or a long value was cut short. Repeat Phase 1 and copy the whole note. If it still fails, rotate the value at the service that issued it and run Phase 2.

> 👁 **Expected result**
>
> The site builds and serves without a missing-environment-variable error.

Phase 2 — Update a value

A key was rotated or replaced at the service that issued it.

2.1 Obtain the new value from the service that issued it

2.2 Open `ENV – <Client> (.env.local)` in 1Password

2.3 Click Edit

2.4 Replace the value in place

Leave the variable name and any comment above it untouched.

2.5 Change line 1 to today's date and your name

Keep the format `# UPDATED YYYY-MM-DD – <name>`.

2.6 Click Save

> ⚠ **Missing screenshot**
>
> Expected an image at `fig_HGM-SOP-WEB-001_f3-edit.png` — The note in edit mode with the date header line selected.

2.7 Post the change in the Web Team Google Chat group

Nothing propagates automatically. This message is the entire mechanism.

POST THIS IN WEB TEAM CHAT

ENV updated for <Client> — re-copy before your next local run.

2.8 Update your own `.env.local`

Repeat tasks 1.4 and 1.8.

Phase 3 — Add a new variable

The project needs a value that is not in the note yet.

3.1 Obtain the value from the service that issues it

3.2 Open `ENV – <Client> (.env.local)` in 1Password

3.3 Click Edit

3.4 Add a comment line stating what the variable is for and which service issues it

3.5 Add the variable below it as `NAME=value`, on its own line

3.6 Change line 1 to today's date and your name

3.7 Click Save

3.8 Post the addition in the Web Team Google Chat group

POST THIS IN WEB TEAM CHAT

New variable added to ENV for <Client> — re-copy before your next local run.

Phase 4 — Give someone access to a project

Someone new needs to run the project locally.

4.1 Ask Gillian or Kyle to add the person to the client's vault

In the **Web Team** Google Chat group. Where a `<Client> – Dev` vault exists, use that one.

Expected result

They appear in the vault's member list in 1Password.

4.2 Send them this SOP ID and tell them to follow Phase 1

Send them no credential directly

Everything they need is in the vault once access is granted. Sending a value “just to unblock them” is the exact thing this SOP exists to stop.

Phase 5 — Send someone a direct link to the note

Use this when someone with vault access asks where the file is. A private link opens the item in their own 1Password app, so they do not have to search.

5.1 Confirm the person already has access to the client's vault

If they do not → run Phase 4 first. A private link will not work for them until they do.

5.2 Open `ENV – <Client> (.env.local)` in 1Password

The item must be in a shared vault

Private links do not resolve for items in a Private vault.

5.3 Click the ellipsis … on the item

Available in the desktop app, the browser extension, and on 1password.com.

5.4 Select Copy Private Link

Missing screenshot

Expected an image at `fig_HGM-SOP-WEB-001_f4-link.png` — The item ellipsis menu open in 1Password with Copy Private Link highlighted, showing Share as a separate entry.

Copy Private Link, never Share

The same menu offers **Share**, which creates a link anyone can open *without* a 1Password account and which reveals the full contents of the note. Never use **Share** on an ENV note. **Copy Private Link** resolves only for people who already have vault access, which is why it is safe to paste into chat.

5.5 Paste the link into the Web Team Google Chat group, or into your reply to their request

If the link opens to an error or an empty item

They are not signed in to the HGM account, or do not have that client's vault. Go back to task 5.1.

Expected result

They open the link and land directly on the item in their own 1Password app.

Phase 6 — Remove someone's access

Removing vault access does not revoke a credential the person already copied to their laptop. Rotation is required, not optional.

6.1 Ask Gillian or Kyle to remove the person from every client vault they held

6.2 List every project they had access to

Write the list down before you start rotating. Phase 6 is the one procedure where losing your place has real consequences.

6.3 Rotate every credential below, at the service that issued it

For each project on your list. Record each new value as you go.

CREDENTIAL	ROTATE AT
Hostaway API key	Hostaway
Stripe secret key	Stripe
Stripe webhook signing secret	Stripe — regenerate after rotating the secret key
Resend API key	Resend
Supabase service role key (its highest-privilege key, which bypasses every access rule)	Supabase
GoHighLevel PIT (private integration token, its per-location API key)	GoHighLevel
Meta CAPI (Conversions API) access token	Meta
`ADMIN_SECRET`, `ACTION_LINK_SECRET`, `SYNC_SECRET`, `CRON_SECRET`	Generated per site — regenerate each one

6.4 Replace every rotated value in each affected note

Open the note, click **Edit**, paste each new value, then change line 1 to today's date and your name.

Expected result

Every affected note carries today's date on line 1.

6.5 Post completion in the Web Team Google Chat group, naming each project you rotated

POST THIS IN WEB TEAM CHAT

Access removed for <name>. Rotated and updated ENV for: <project>, <project>.

04 EXCEPTIONS AND EDGE CASES

Every credential in the note is usable

Because the complete file is stored, a note may contain production credentials (keys to the live client system, which handle real bookings and real money). Anyone with vault access can use them, and anyone who has already copied the file keeps them until they are rotated. Phase 6 is the only thing that closes that.

A client vault shared beyond the dev team

Create `<Client> – Dev` and store the note there instead. Do not put a `.env` note in a vault that people outside the dev team can open.

A key was sent through chat, email or a shared drive

Rotate it at the service that issued it, update the note (Phase 2), then delete the message.

Someone outside the HGM 1Password account needs a value

A private link will not work for them. Do not use **Share** on the ENV note. Create a separate temporary item containing only the value they need, share that, then delete it.

Revisit this SOP ahead of its review date

If a stale local copy causes an incident or a repeated time loss; if a contractor joins who needs access cut off cleanly; or if more than four people need local access to the same project.

What this SOP does not protect against

Stated plainly so nobody assumes more than is true. Plaintext copies still exist on individual laptops — this stops files moving through chat and email, it does not eliminate local copies. Nobody is notified

automatically when a value changes; standing rule 3 is the entire mechanism. And a credential someone has copied cannot be recalled — Phase 6 is the only way to close it.

If you are stuck

Ask Claude first, with the task number and what you see. For vault access — a missing vault, a link that will not open, adding or removing someone — ask Gillian (Operations Manager) or Kyle Zinger (Web & Content Specialist), the 1Password admins, in the **Web Team** Google Chat group. For anything else, post there too.

05 FINAL CHECKLIST AFTER REMOVING ACCESS

Phase 6 is the one flow here with a point of no return: until every credential is rotated, the person who left still holds working keys. Run this before you call it done.

- [ ] The person is removed from every client vault they held
- [ ] You have a written list of every project they had access to
- [ ] Every credential in the task 6.3 table is rotated, for every project on that list
- [ ] Stripe's webhook signing secret was regenerated *after* the secret key
- [ ] Every per-site secret — `ADMIN_SECRET`, `ACTION_LINK_SECRET`, `SYNC_SECRET`, `CRON_SECRET` — was regenerated
- [ ] Every affected note carries today's date and your name on line 1
- [ ] Each affected site still runs locally with the new values
- [ ] Completion is posted in the Web Team Google Chat group, naming each project

06 RELATED DOCUMENTS

- `HGM-SOP-OPS-001` — Produce and publish an HGM SOP
- HGM-SOP-WEB-002 — Take a website change request from Asana to live
- 1Password item links and **Copy Private Link** — https://support.1password.com/item-links/
- 1Password item categories and Secure Notes — https://support.1password.com/item-categories/

07 REVISION HISTORY

DATE	VERSION	AUTHOR	CHANGE SUMMARY
2026-08-11	1.0	Kyle Zinger	Initial release
2026-09-01	1.1	Kyle Zinger	Rebuilt to the current house style. Purpose and scope merged; the four standing rules moved into a rules block; the flat 6.1–6.6 procedure restructured into six phases of numbered tasks; a final checklist added for the access-removal flow. No change to the process itself. The four screenshots remain uncaptured.
2026-10-15	1.2	Kyle Zinger	Loom review layout (house style v1.9). Roles, definitions and troubleshooting removed: terms are explained where first used, and each fix sits in the task it belongs to. Standing rules shortened; prerequisites collapse; an If you are stuck note; a copy-to-Claude button on the final checklist; links to other SOPs open in the portal.

REMEMBER

“A private link is a pointer, not a credential. Everything else — the file, the key, the value — stays in the vault.”

Questions?
Web Team Google Chat group